

Lesson Plan

Topic: Voice and Character – Introduction to Dramatic Reading

Teacher:	Ed Rush	Date:	22 June, 2026
Class:	M3 (all M3 classes)	Duration:	46 minutes
CEFR Level:	B2	Lesson Shape:	E (Receptive Skills (Traditional))
Materials:	• Speaking test feedback slips (individual) • Breaking Bad table read – Blood Money argument scene (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MqfSr8Gu9zI) • Breaking Bad filmed scene – Blood Money (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3A-Ck_2Na6s) • The Outsiders movie – drive-in scene, 19:08 to 23:30 (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CvyYEWSK1-w&t=19m08s) • The Outsiders Chapter 2 (from ‘Dally came striding back...’ to end of chapter) • Whiteboard / screen for comparison table		

Lesson Aim

Main aim: By the end of the lesson, learners will be better able to identify how actors use voice to create character and to apply this awareness in a group dramatic reading of Chapter 2 of The Outsiders.

Subsidiary aim: Learners will have developed the sub-skills of watching for detail (comparing table read vs filmed performance) and reading aloud with character-appropriate intonation, pace, and emotion.

= Lesson Stages

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Time	Goal	Procedure	Int
STAGE 1: Lead-in – Speaking Feedback			
8 min	To surface the problems of flat intonation, fear, and hesitation from the first speaking performances and to frame the lesson’s purpose	• Return individual feedback slips from the speaking test. Give Ss 1 min to read silently. • Elicit: “What patterns do you see in your feedback?” Board common themes – flat voice, long pauses, nervous laugh, too quiet. • Pair share: “Tell your partner one thing you want to improve today.” 1 min.	T-Ss / Ss-Ss

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		Bring class back. "These are all speaking problems – but they're also acting problems. Today we're going to watch how professional actors solve them."	
STAGE 2: Pre-watching – Setting the Frame			
2 min	To activate schema around table reads and set a focused viewing task	- Ask: "What's a table read? Has anyone seen one?" Elicit or explain – actors sit around a table, read the script aloud, no costumes, no sets, no cameras. - Set task: "We're going to watch the SAME scene twice. First, the table read – actors reading at a table, voices only. Watch their VOICES. How do they show emotion and character using ONLY their voice?"	T-Ss
STAGE 3: While-watching – Table Read + Filmed Comparison			
5 min	To observe how professional actors use voice to create emotional authenticity and compare this to the final filmed performance	- Play the Breaking Bad table read – Blood Money argument scene, Walt and Jesse (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MqfSr8Gu9zl). 1.5-2 min. Aaron Paul's emotional read. - Then play the equivalent filmed scene from the episode (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3A-Ck_2Na6s). 1.5-2 min. - Quick pair discussion (1 min): "What was the same? What was different?" - Whole-class feedback. Board a comparison table:	T-Ss
STAGE 4: Post-watching – Elicit the Principle			
3 min	To draw out the core principle – voice creates character, and inhabiting a role reduces self-consciousness	- Elicit: "Why does Aaron Paul's table read work, even without acting? What is he doing with his voice?" - Guide to: He's not being 'Aaron Paul' – he's being Jesse. The character frees him. - Connect back to feedback: "Your flat intonation and fear come from being YOURSELF under pressure. What if you were someone else?" "The actors in Breaking Bad get into character. We're going to do the same thing with The Outsiders."	T-Ss
STAGE 5: Pre-reading – Meet the Characters			
6 min	To familiarize students with the characters who	Play the Outsiders drive-in scene from 19:08 to 23:30 (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CvyYEWSK1-	T-Ss / Ss-Ss

Time	Goal	Procedure	Int
	speak in the Chapter 2 passage and their personas	w&t=19m08s). All six characters appear. • Set the focus: "Watch each character. How do they speak? What does their voice tell you about who they are?" • After the clip, elicit voice descriptors for each character and board them: • Assign characters for the read-aloud (depending on class size, multiple Ss can share a character or rotate).	
STAGE 6: While-reading – Group Read-Aloud			
22 min	To read Chapter 2 aloud with character-appropriate voice, applying the awareness developed in the preceding stages	• Ss open Chapter 2 at the line: "Dally came striding back with an armful of Cokes..." • Teacher narrates the non-dialogue sections (Ponyboy's narration), or assign a strong reader as Ponyboy. • Each character's dialogue is read by the assigned student(s): • Teacher calls in: "Johnny, how would HE say that? Remember – he's scared of Dally but found courage. What does that sound like?" • If time permits, rotate characters and re-read a short section so different Ss try a different voice. • End by acknowledging strong moments: "That moment when Cherry threw the Coke – we felt it because that student read it with real anger."	S (individual reading) / T-Ss
STAGE 7: Wrap-up (if time allows, otherwise spills to Lesson 2)			
0 min	To consolidate the day's learning and preview the next lesson	• Quick round: "One word – what did you learn about using your voice today?" • Preview: "Next lesson, you'll create your own scene from The Outsiders and perform it – table read first, then full performance."	T-Ss